

product, they threw in many free accessories like its R.O.B robot and a light gun. They also generated a lot more buzz for their product by releasing two exclusive sets: one that included Super Mario Bros, its super-popular video game franchise, and a deluxe set that came with a light gun and three games. These sets sold in numbers of around 60 million over six years.

In comparison, Sega's entry into the North American market was a little more unstable. Sega's SG-1000 didn't have much to offer that was drastically different from earlier consoles, such as the ColecoVision and contemporary computers such as the MSX. To recoup their losses, Sega went back to production and made progress on a system that would prove to be an equal match for the NES. This led to the release of Sega's Master System in 1985.



Nintendo's NES

Initially, the Master System was launched as the Sega Mark III in Japan in 1985. After a certain level of success, Sega decided to redesign and market the console as the Master System and release it to the North American market in 1986, 1987 in Europe, and 1989 in Brazil. To set it apart from its direct competitor, the NES, the Master System was released with accessories such as a light gun and 3D glasses which were designed to work with a range of games that demanded the use of these devices.

Even so, despite its superior hardware, the Master System failed to make any significant impact against the NES, mostly because of the lack of